Working-Age People Living in Poverty

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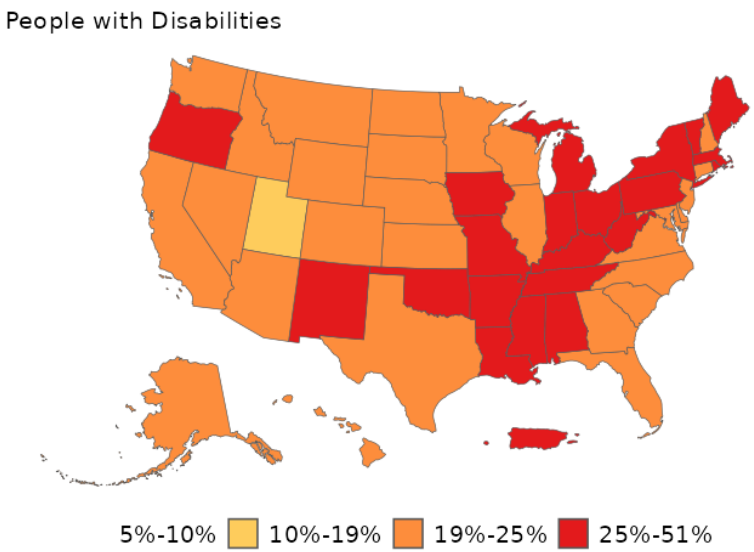
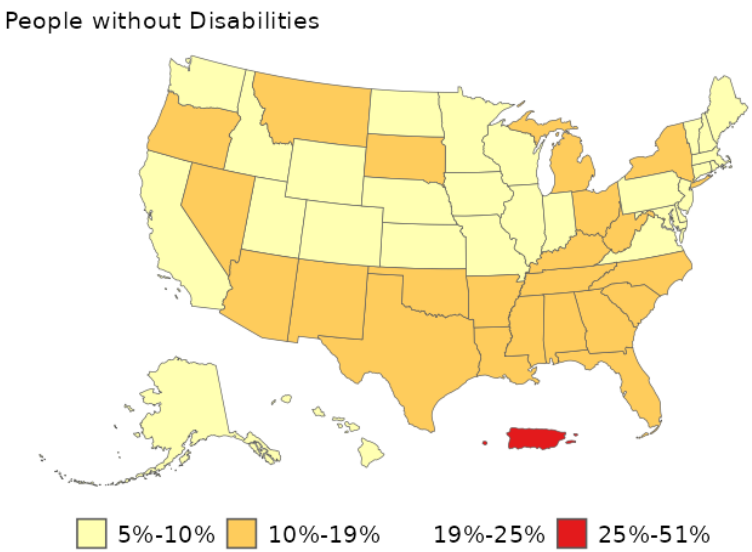
The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) rests on the idea that people with disabilities should be assured equal opportunity and economic self-sufficiency.[1] Yet, people with disabilities remain over twice as likely to live in poverty.[2]

Despite the ADA's call for economic freedom and equal opportunity, some states are doing better than others to ensure that people with disabilities are not living in poverty. The maps and tables below display state percentages for working-aged people with disabilities (ages 18-64) who are below the poverty line. Higher percentages (represented by a darker color) mean more disabled people are living below the poverty line.

The added strain the continuing COVID-19 pandemic places on those living in poverty highlights the ways in which disability and poverty remain intertwined. People with disabilities make up less than 13% of the United States population, but over 50% of its people live in long-term poverty.[3] It is a reminder that every state has the responsibility to ensure people with disabilities can live free from poverty.





To explore the interactive version of this map, visit the [Interactive color-coded map.]

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Percentages are calculated from TableS2602 of American Community Survey (ACS) 2018 data.[4]

Tables: Percent of People with Disabilities and without Disabilities (Age 18-64) Living Below Poverty Line

State	Disability	No Disability
Montana	23.6%	10.7%
Nebraska	23.0%	8.7%
Nevada	21.7%	10.5%
New Hampshire	20.5%	5.3%
New Jersey	19.7%	7.6%
New Mexico	29.1%	15.5%
New York	28.8%	10.8%
North Carolina	25.0%	10.7%
North Dakota	23.9%	9.6%
Ohio	28.2%	10.4%
Oklahoma	26.1%	12.8%
Oregon	26.6%	10.1%
Pennsylvania	26.3%	9.0%
Rhode Island	25.2%	8.4%
South Carolina	25.0%	11.7%
South Dakota	24.8%	10.1%
Tennessee	26.5%	10.8%
Texas	22.1%	11.1%
Utah	17.8%	7.8%
Vermont	27.2%	8.6%
Virginia	20.7%	8.3%
Washington	22.4%	8.1%
West Virginia	30.8%	14.1%

[1] Americans With Disabilities Act of 1990. Pub. L. 101-336. § 1. 26 July 1990. 104 Stat. 328.
[2] U.S. Census Bureau. American Community Survey 5-year estimates (2019–2023). Table ACSDT5Y2023.C18130
[3] National Council on Disability (NCD), 2017—Progress Report. National Council on Disability

Wisconsin	23.7%	8.8%
Wyoming	21.4%	9.6%
Puerto Rico	50.3%	36.3%

State	Disability	No Disability
Alabama	26.6%	12.7%
Alaska	20.5%	8.7%
Arizona	22.8%	10.8%
Arkansas	28.9%	12.8%
California	22.5%	9.9%
Colorado	19.9%	8.2%
Connecticut	24.2%	8.0%
Delaware	20.4%	8.9%
District of Columbia	35.2%	10.8%
Florida	22.4%	10.5%
Georgia	23.0%	10.8%
Hawaii	21.5%	8.6%
Idaho	20.4%	9.2%
Illinois	24.5%	9.5%
Indiana	25.0%	10.0%
Iowa	25.0%	9.5%
Kansas	24.7%	9.8%
Kentucky	30.7%	12.5%
Louisiana	30.0%	15.5%
Maine	26.6%	8.2%
Maryland	22.3%	7.3%

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Massachusetts	25.3%	7.7%
Michigan	27.1%	10.6%
Minnesota	24.5%	7.3%
Mississippi	29.9%	15.3%
Missouri	27.4%	9.9%

Americans with Disabilities Act Participatory Action Research Consortium (ADA-PARC) is a collaborative national project to examine participation disparities experienced by people with disabilities. For more information on your

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[3] National Council on Disability (NCD), 2017—Progress Report. National Council on Disability